

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a website advertising standing desks:

Standing desks

It seems the world is finally realising that humans evolved to stand, not to sit. The evidence is mounting to show that spending too much time sitting at work, during your commute and for leisure increases your risk of several diseases and early death. Unfortunately for us, technological advances and design experts have made sitting more comfortable. Australian adults, for example, now sit for an average of nearly nine hours a day, which is longer than most people spend sleeping.

So, could it be time to buy a **standing desk**?

Many people know when they've been sitting too long, because their back or neck gets sore. But it's what you can't feel or see that you may need to be concerned about. Canadian researcher, Dr Katzmarzyk, found that those who sit for long periods of time during the day have nearly a one-third higher risk of early death than those who stand a lot.

Our message is to stand up, sit less and move more. Alternating between sitting and standing increases muscular movement, stimulates blood flow and results in more calories burnt and healthier blood sugar levels. Recent findings show that alternating between 30 minutes of sitting and standing can improve blood sugar levels, particularly after a meal.

Now, if you're thinking about getting a standing desk, but are concerned about your concentration and productivity, there's some good news. Research shows task performance such as typing, reading and performing cognitive tests is largely unaffected by standing desks.



A standing desk

Your group is preparing a presentation to introduce standing desks to your classmates. You may want to talk about:

- advantages of standing desks
- disadvantages of standing desks
- how to make the presentation interesting
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to have a standing desk?
2. When you aren't at school, do you spend long periods of time sitting down?
3. Do you think you spend too much time sitting down in your life?
4. Would you prefer a job that involves mostly sitting or standing?
5. Do you think the concept of a standing restaurant would work in Hong Kong?
6. Do you think it is better to sit or stand at a music concert?
7. Do you think it is a good idea that people stand up in meetings at work?
8. Do you agree that your concentration would not be affected if you were working at a standing desk?